

Kiah Tasman (PhD)

6 Ashgrove Rd
Bristol
BS5 6JR
[+447972281334](tel:+447972281334)
kiahtasman@live.co.uk

Education

University of Bristol / PhD in Life Sciences

October 2015 - March 2020,

Thesis title: 'Determining the effects of neonicotinoid pesticides on the foraging rhythmicity and sleep of bumblebees'

Supervisors: Drs James Hodge & Sean Rands

Research Project looking at agriculture, sustainability and conservation, focused on the persistence of neonicotinoid pesticides in the environment and the effects of these on the foraging of beneficial insects such as bumblebees. Involved maintaining bumblebee colonies and carrying out behavioural assays with foragers, creating, analysing and displaying large data sets, presenting data orally at conferences and in regular reports, carrying out extensive literature reviews and writing academic papers. Use of programs such as SPSS, GraphPad, Microsoft Excel, Publisher and Dynamics and Adobe InDesign and Photoshop.

University of Sussex / BSc (Hons) in Biology

September 2011 - July 2014

Upper second class honours. Dissertation title: The chemical composition of the alarm pheromone of the leaf cutting ants *Atta cephalotes* and *Acromyrmex octospinosus* and potential use for crop defence.

Relevant Experience

Co-founder and Director/ Bristol Transformed

March 2018- Present

Annual multi day, multi venue festival of art, politics and culture that attracts over 700 attendees and 100 speakers and volunteers. Secured funding, ran volunteer teams, organised speaker timetabling and guest registration and publicised via radio interviews, social media, local news outlets and posters and leaflets. Focused on topics such as a Green Jobs, a National Food Service, Community Organising and others. Collected and collated qualitative feedback via surveys and compiled for the other directors. Emailed updates, registered attendees and handled all attendee data in accordance with GDPR legislation.

Bristol National Food Service/ Bristol Phone Line Volunteer

March 2019- Present

Organising the delivery of free cooked food and veg boxes to people currently struggling to make ends meet. Collecting feedback on service via phone surveys and reporting back

BASE cafe/ Volunteer

July 2018- July 2019

Cooking weekly meals for the pay what you can community café

Employment

Seabird Population Survey/ Field Assistant

February 2020, Little Tobago

Assisted in a survey of the Red Billed Tropic Bird and Audubon's Shearwater populations on Little Tobago Bird Sanctuary.

The Guppy Project / Field Assistant

November 2019- March 2020, Trinidad and Tobago

Carried out fieldwork for the Guppy Project in Trinidad and Tobago, catching, identifying, weighing and photographing guppies from populations under different predation levels for research into rapid evolution and its interaction with local ecology. Carried out data entry and checking data base for errors.

University of Bristol/ Teaching Assistant

September 2016-May 2019

Assisted with field trips, laboratory sessions, seminars and marking for Zoology BSc courses, including Statistics, Ecology, Biodiversity and Conservation modules.

African Penguin Conservation Project/ Field Assistant

March 2018-June 2018

Carried out a field season on Robben Island, South Africa, as a research assistant and team leader on the African Penguin Conservation Project, with Earth Watch and Bristol Zoo. This role involved managing teams of volunteers to closely monitor penguin nests.

University of Sussex/ Field Assistant

August 2013

Carried out a field season in Ecuador assisting on a project studying the diversity and density of epiphytes at different altitudes in the cloud forest.

Laboratory of Apiculture and Social Insects/ Field Assistant

February 2013 -August 2013

Helped to maintain apiaries for research into hygienic behaviour and *Varroa* mites in honeybees. Also decoded and analysed honeybee waggle dances, caught and tagged foragers and trained them to feeders and helped organise and deliver science outreach sessions for the public and seminars for undergraduate students.

Public Outreach

Outreach Workshops in Pollination and Sustainable Agriculture

Green Man Festival 2017 & 2018 / BoomTown Festival 2017 / Secret Garden Party 2016 / Bristol Neuroscience Festival 2016 & 2017 / Bee and Pollination Festival 2017 & 2018

Skills

Data Collection, Analysis and Presentation / Writing of reports and academic papers / Creation of Infographics and Posters / Handling personal data in accordance with GDPR / Organisation and publicisation of events / Working with a range of stakeholders

References

Dr James Hodge, University of Bristol, PhD Supervisor, james.hodge@bristol.ac.uk
Dr Sean Rands, University of Bristol, PhD supervisor, sean.rands@bristol.ac.uk

